

September 11th, 2026
Week 37
Volume 282, Issue 1252

QUOTE
of the
WEEK

"The art of being wise is the art of knowing what to overlook."

- William James

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

Click "Ctrl" + below to launch the GMS Weekly Summary Podcast



ROUTES TIGHTEN, BIDS RISE

Last week the shooting returned to the Gulf. This week the risk spread west. Houthis forces captured Mocha and the strategically placed Mayun, or Perim, Island at Bab al-Mandab, putting fresh pressure on Red Sea routing while Hormuz remains operational but far from normal. For commercial shipping, the immediate variables are familiar: passage, insurance, security and delay. One chokepoint has not cleared before another has tightened.

Oil reacted accordingly. Brent moved above USD 107 per barrel early Friday and WTI above USD 103 as markets priced the additional threat to Middle East exports and transit. The move adds voyage and bunker costs across the basin, but the larger recycling consequence sits elsewhere. High energy prices and disrupted routing are supporting earning opportunities for ships that might otherwise have started moving toward the beaches.

Dry freight remains the clearer constraint. The Baltic Dry Index stood at 3,521 on Thursday, with Capesizes at 6,122, Panamaxs at 2,409 and Supramaxes at 1,713. The index has eased from this week's highs but remains at levels that keep ageing bulkers trading, while second hand values continue to give owners another exit before recycling. The beaches are bidding against both daily earnings and asset values, and neither is presently helping supply.

The macro picture was busy enough to matter. U.S. August CPI held at 3.4% year-on-year, with the monthly increase accelerating to 0.4%. The Indian Rupee weakened toward 95.79 against the Dollar, surrendering much of last week's improvement, while the Pakistani Rupee remained near 277.35 and Bangladesh Bank's latest reference rate stood around 123.14. The Turkish Lira weakened through 48.6, while the TCMB held its policy rate at 37% on Thursday. India's clean currency tailwind from last week has therefore largely disappeared.

At the beaches, scarcity is finally pulling competition back upward. Several smaller dry bulk sales appeared this week, with a starved Bangladesh market the chief beneficiary after underperforming through recent weeks. Chattogram buyers have returned with firmer intent as workable candidates emerge. Pakistan remains the leading destination but without August's blanket urgency, while India continues to extract its strongest numbers from specialist and non-ferrous-rich tonnage rather than conventional steel ships.

Physical waterfront activity is improving at the same time. Chattogram has fresh arrivals into its current tide period, Gadani has received three additional bulkers and converted a previously arrived tanker into a delivery, while Alang has another sizeable general cargo arrival. Yet the distinction remains critical. Much of the tonnage reaching the beaches was secured earlier, and today's freight and second hand markets are still preventing the next recycling cycle from being properly replenished.

Pakistan therefore holds the lead, Bangladesh is bidding harder because its yards need feeding, and India remains active through its specialist lane despite weaker currency support. Fresh sales have returned, but not at the volume required to loosen candidate scarcity. Owners still have earnings, resale options and time on their side. The ships can trade, so the beaches must pay.

Highlights:

- Routes tighten.

- Oil tops 100.

- Freight holds.

- Bangladesh rises.

Scan to download
/ view the Weekly
on the GMS App!



GMS market rankings / pricing for week 37 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

**BUYERS STARVED, SALES STIR*****Bids rebound.***

Last week Chattogram's bid was waiting. This week it stopped waiting. Having underperformed through the recent run while Pakistan secured tonnage and India developed its specialist lane, Bangladesh has become the clearest beneficiary of an increasingly thin candidate list. Several smaller dry bulk units have been circulated and concluded at firmer levels, including the 7,078 LDT Handymax bulker UNIORDER, sold by Indonesian owners Waruna at region USD 450/LDT net, 'as is' Belawan. The basis is not directly comparable with a delivered Chattogram quotation, but the transaction confirms what the desk has been seeing: when a workable hull appears, the buyer is there.

Arrivals build.

The waterfront is beginning to reflect the same requirement. The 5,602 LDT bulk carrier Dina Ocean arrived on September 7, while the 1,961 LDT tanker Leo Star arrived on September 5. Both are arrivals, not deliveries. With the September 10 to 13 tide window now in progress, Chattogram has an opportunity to move physical tonnage onto the plots. The useful distinction remains intact: waterfront activity is improving and fresh business has reappeared, but neither yet amounts to a steady supply cycle. The current tide dates continue directly from last week's schedule.

Steel flat.

Local steel did not provide the catalyst for the improved vessel market. The supplied steel series remained unchanged throughout the week at BDT 64,000 per ton, approximately USD 522.24 per ton. The Taka was similarly orderly, with Bangladesh Bank's September 10 reference rate around BDT 123.14 to the Dollar. August inflation provided a modest macro improvement, easing to 8.26% from July's 8.32%, with food inflation falling to 7.02%. Vessel values are therefore improving without a corresponding local steel rally. Requirement and scarcity are doing the work.

Chattogram looks considerably healthier than it did a week ago. Recyclers have capacity, the post-monsoon operating rhythm is back, and fresh dry sales are beginning to test where the market can clear. The constraint remains upstream. Freight and second hand values mean buyers can improve considerably faster than owners become sellers. Bangladesh has found its appetite again. What it still needs is a menu.

MARKET SALE REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
Uniorder	Bulker	7,078	USD 450/LT LDT ('as is' Belawan)

INDIA



SPECIALISTS PAY, RUPEE RETREATS

Alang's specialist market continues to produce levels well removed from its conventional position on the sub-continent board. Strong numbers on passenger vessels, reefers and other non-ferrous-rich units have now extended to the Gearbulk-controlled general cargo vessel Mandarin Arrow. The approximately 14.8k LDT unit was reportedly sold at region USD 510/LDT for a limited selection of HKC recycling yards, with about 130 tonnes of bunkers remaining on delivery. This is not a new benchmark for an ordinary bulker. It is another example of India paying differently for ships that bring more than straightforward steel weight.

Specialists pay.

The port report advances the story immediately. Mandarin Arrow is recorded as arriving at Alang on September 10, within the September 8 to 16 delivery-tide period. It is an arrival, not a reported delivery. Specialist tonnage therefore continues to generate physical activity even while India's standard dry and tanker numbers remain behind Pakistan and Bangladesh. Local fundamentals were less supportive this week. Alang plate opened at INR 42,100 per ton, eased to INR 42,000, then INR 41,800, before recovering to INR 42,000 on Friday. More importantly, the supplied USD equivalent fell from approximately USD 445.55 to USD 438.64 per ton as the Rupee weakened. USD/INR moved toward 95.79 on Friday as elevated crude added pressure to the currency. The steel finished almost where it started in local terms. The currency removed much of the Dollar benefit.

Rupee retreats.

India consequently remains third on conventional dry, tanker and container tonnage, and that distinction should not be blurred. Yet specialist, non-ferrous-rich and compliance-sensitive candidates continue to draw considerably stronger attention than ordinary units, giving Alang a flow of opportunities that the standard board alone does not capture. Alang is not closing every price gap. It is finding ships where the gap matters less.

Mandarin arrives.

MARKET SALE REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
Mandarin Arrow	General Cargo	14,824	Region USD 510/LDT (limited HKC-compliant yards only, with abt. 130 Ts bunkers on delivery)

PAKISTAN



LEADER HOLDS, URGENCY THINS

Top holds.

Gadani remains the top-placed market for another week, but the progression from August is now complete. First the bid outran the hulls, then the hulls arrived, and now enough immediate requirement has been satisfied for some demand to run dry. This is a correction in the depth of competition, not the disappearance of demand. The 7,381 LDT bulker PORTLAND II was committed this week at a firm USD 521/LDT, evidence that the right smaller dry unit can still locate a competitive buyer. One sale proves the market clears. It does not recreate August's bidding frenzy.

Waterfront fills.

The waterfront increasingly explains why recyclers can afford to be more selective. The 6,141 LDT bulker Maria arrived September 9, the 2,449 LDT bulker Spring arrived September 6 and the 5,000 LDT bulker BR Glory arrived September 4. Meanwhile, the 4,990 LDT tanker Lyra, previously carried as an arrival, is now recorded as delivered September 4. Lina F remains an arrival from September 1 and Larus from August 27. Gadani's empty-beach problem is therefore firmly behind it. Actual steel-bearing tonnage is now feeding the system. Nothing in the local steel or currency market suggests a fundamental deterioration beneath the bid. Plate remained unchanged throughout the week at PKR 200,000 per ton, approximately USD 719.94 per ton. The State Bank's September 10 M2M revaluation rate stood at PKR 277.3522 to the Dollar and the policy rate remains 11.5%. SBP reserves also increased to USD 18.33 billion as of September 4. August's 11.1% inflation reading remains the operative print. The commercial point is the same as last week: steel and currency have held while the urgency beneath vessel pricing has eased.

Urgency thins.

Pakistan therefore keeps first place, but the market underneath that ranking is thinner than the headline suggests. The most aggressive recyclers have ships in hand, second-tier buyers will not automatically reproduce the numbers required during the August run, and attractive candidates remain scarce enough to prevent any wholesale retreat. The appetite remains. The queue of hungry yards is shorter.

MARKET SALE REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
Portland II	Bulker	7,381	USD 521/LT LDT

TURKEY

RATE HOLDS, BOARD LIFTS



The TCMB supplied the week's principal Turkish event on Thursday and chose continuity. The one-week repo rate was held at 37%, with the overnight lending and borrowing rates unchanged at 40% and 35.5% respectively. The Bank said the underlying inflation trend is decelerating but specifically identified elevated energy prices from geopolitical developments as an upside risk. August CPI remains at 31.51%, while USD/TRY moved through 48.6 into fresh record territory by Friday. Last week's combination of easing inflation and a weakening Lira therefore remains firmly in place.

Rate holds.

For Aliaga recyclers, the currency continues to limit Dollar-denominated buying power. The interesting change this week comes from the GMS desk board itself, which has been marked higher across dry, tanker and container tonnage. Even after that adjustment, however, Turkey remains structurally detached from conventional sub-continent competition.

Board lifts.

Aliaga's business continues to depend on specialist tonnage, geography, European regulatory access and Basel-compliant trades rather than an attempt to chase South Asian numbers. The macro backdrop has not suddenly become friendlier and candidate flow remains selective. The higher board therefore represents improved buying levels within Turkey's own lane, rather than any change in the hierarchy between Aliaga and the sub-continent.

Niche steady.

The rate held. The currency slipped. The number moved.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 37 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	Softening	500 / LDT	525 / LDT	535 / LDT
2	Bangladesh	Improving	490 / LDT	515 / LDT	525 / LDT
3	India	Improving	465 / LDT	485 / LDT	495 / LDT
4	Turkey	Improving	290 / LDT	310 / LDT	320 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- **44.4 billion kWh of energy** estimated to have been saved through ship recycling at Alang is enough to run a 1 GW power station continuously for more than five years.
- **124.5 million barrels of oil** estimated to have been saved through ship recycling at Alang is equivalent to nearly 19.8 billion litres, enough to fill almost 8,000 Olympic-sized swimming pools.
- **753 trillion BTUs of energy** saved through ship recycling at Alang is equivalent to approximately 221 TWh, comparable to the annual output of about **25 one-gigawatt power stations** operating continuously.

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
October 02 - Mahatma Gandhi's Birthday	September 08 - September 16 September 25 - October 03

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
20–21 October 2026 – Durga Puja	September 10 – September 13 September 26 – September 29

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	TURKEY
November 09 – Allama Iqbal Day	28–29 October 2026 – Republic Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of September 11, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Mandarin Arrow	14,825	General Cargo	Arrived September 10

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of September 11, 2026

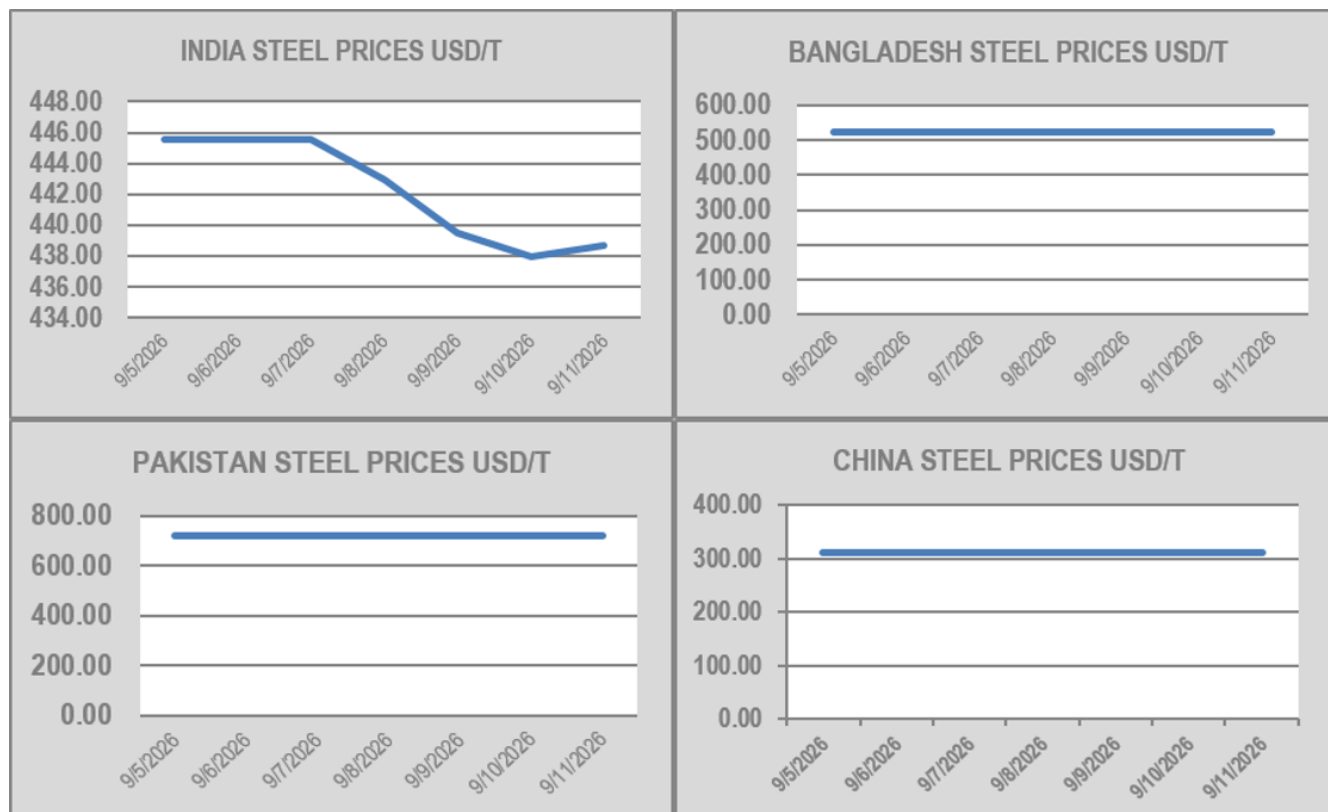
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Dina Ocean	5,602	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 07
2	Leo Star	1,961	Tanker	Arrived September 05

GADANI - Port Position as of September 11, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Maria	6,141	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 09
2	Spring	2,449	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 06
3	BR Glory	5,000	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 04
4	Lyra	4,990	Tanker	<i>Delivered September 04</i>
5	Lina F	5,688	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 01
6	Larus	2,632	General Cargo	Arrived August 27

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
9/5/2026	445.55	42,100.00	719.94	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	311.91
9/6/2026	445.55	42,100.00	719.94	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	311.91
9/7/2026	445.55	42,100.00	719.94	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	311.91
9/8/2026	442.94	42,000.00	719.94	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	311.91
9/9/2026	439.49	41,800.00	719.94	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	311.91
9/10/2026	437.97	41,800.00	719.94	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	311.91
9/11/2026	438.64	42,000.00	719.94	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	311.91



www.gmsinc.net



GMS_Leadership



GMS Leadership



snp@gmsinc.net

Athens, Greece Tel: +30.210.899.0669
Cumberland, USA Tel: +1.301.759.9240
Hamburg, Germany Tel: +49.40. 3197.9963
Shanghai, China Tel: +86.216.075.1900
Singapore Tel: +65.6823.8037

Bhavnagar, India Tel: +91.278.300.5253
Dubai, UAE Tel: +971.4.423.0720
New York, USA Tel: +1.240.505.9716
Seoul, South Korea Tel: +82.10.4650.0720
Tokyo, Japan Tel: +81.3.5453.6311